SOUTH LAKE HOME EDUCATORS

SLHE

Video Game Creation

Lesson 15

Ready to Show

Semester 1, Week 15 - Level 3 Refined Milestone - Capstone Presentation

At a Glance

Lesson 15 objectives & format

By the end of today, students will:

- ✓ Self-assess against the full capstone checklist
- ✓ Complete a final, prioritized polish pass
- ✓ Present a working game confidently to the class
- ✓ Reach the Level 3 Refined milestone

Today Is Different

- No lecture demo, no new mechanics today
- A workshop-and-showcase day
- No new assets - this IS the capstone
- Bring: your own Lesson 14 project, nothing else
- Demo laptop on standby, backup only

IGDA framework tie-in: Production - scoping, finishing, and presenting a project (intermediate); all Five Disciplines, in review.

Today's Agenda

0:00 - 0:10	Welcome back, capstone reflection, milestone framing
POLISH TIME	***— Work the Full Capstone Checklist —***
0:10 - 0:55	Fix, tune, and finish - checklist first, extras second
0:55 - 1:00	Presentation logistics, running order / sign-up
PRESENTATIONS	***— About 2 Minutes Each —***
1:00 - 1:50	Play a round, name your game, show your feature
1:50 - 2:00	Closing celebration, look ahead to Semester 2

Welcome Back

Fifteen weeks. A real, finished game.

10 min

Capstone Reflection

10 min

Today is different from every other day this semester:

- ✓ No new code to learn - today you finish, and today you show what you built
- ✓ Since Lesson 1, you've built a game that moves, shoots, scores, wins, loses, sounds, reacts, and escalates
- ✓ About 45 minutes of polish time, then about 2-minute presentations - no slides, no stress

Open your own project from last week today - this IS your capstone. There's nothing separate to submit, and nothing new to bring.

Polish Time

Checklist first. Extras only after that.

45 min

Polish Time

45 min

Work your Handout's checklist top to bottom - in priority order:

1. **Fix anything broken or unchecked**

   A complete, simple game beats a broken ambitious one.

2. **Tune anything unfair or confusing**

   Difficulty, text clarity, sound volume/timing.

3. **Only then: your Lesson 14 feature**

   Or any extra polish, if time and energy remain.

Milestone Moment

What Level 3 Refined actually means.

10 min

Level 3 Refined

10 min

Level 1 MVP (Lesson 6) meant a complete, playable loop. Level 2 Complete (Lesson 11) meant real depth. Level 3 Refined means feature-complete, tested, and polished enough to comfortably share outside of class.

That's not a claim that everything is perfect. It's a claim that your game is DONE - a real, working, presentable arcade game, built by you, over fifteen weeks, in an engine you chose.

However far up the Level ladder you got, a finished game is today's whole point - not a perfect one.

Presentations

Play a round. Tell us about it. That's it.

50 min

Presenting Your Game

50 min

About 2 minutes each. No slides, no notes required - just play while you talk.

1. Name your game, and its core mechanic, in one sentence
2. Play a short round - a hit, a wave clear, a win or loss
3. Point out your chosen Level 3 stretch feature specifically
4. If something breaks live: say what it's supposed to do, and move on

Polish & Presentation Notes

- ✓ Redirect firmly toward fixing and tuning over adding anything new during polish time.
- ✓ Triage: Core Mechanics broken, then Sound/Animation, then Difficulty/Level 3, in that order if time is short.
- ✓ A confident presentation of a Level 1/2 game is a full success today - not every Level 3 item needs to be finished.
- ✓ Hold the 2-minute presentation limit firmly, with a warning at the halfway point.

The Full Capstone, In Review

Core Mechanics	Move, shoot, score, lives, win/lose, restart, waves (L2-11)
Sound	Shoot, explosion, wave clear, game over (L12)
Animation	Hit flash, explosion effect (L13)
Difficulty	Enemy count and speed scale by wave (L14)

Plus: one chosen Level 3 stretch feature - shields, a power-up, a bonus enemy, formation movement, or a title/game-over screen.

Looking Ahead: Semester 2

Semester 2 picks up in a very different place: state machines, enemy/AI behavior, physics, expanding scope with menus and save data, and eventually a much bigger capstone for the CoOp Expo. New this term: testing your own game (and having classmates try it) becomes an ongoing habit, not a one-time thing at the end.

Everything you built this semester stays exactly this valuable: it's proof you can take an idea all the way to done.

Capstone Complete!

Fifteen weeks, one idea, a real finished game - built and shown by you.

Congratulations, Video Game Creation - Semester 1 is in the books.

See you next semester for state machines, AI, and an even bigger build.